OUR LADY OF MONTLIGEON PRAYER GROUP- praying for all the souls in Purgatory meets in Termonbacca, on the last Wednesday each month at 12:30pm. Also in St Joseph's Church Galliagh every Monday after 11am Mass.

PILGRIMAGES TO MEDJUGORJE & LOURDES 2027 Deposits and Savings scheme available on Thursdays in Parochial House from 10.30am-12noon.beginning in October. contact Margaret 07732468511

RACHEL'S VINEYARD: Have you been hurt by abortion? Tel: Michelle 07871765181.

GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS: Is gambling affecting your life? We would like to help. Pick up the phone and ring 028 7135 1329.

ACCORD DERRY MARRIAGE PREPARATION WORKSHOPS November 20th/21st 2026 These courses are now online for booking at www.accordni.com

GIFT AID We are about to claim our Gift Aid for the tax year ending April 2026. If you are a member of our Gift Aid Scheme and have stopped paying tax please get in touch with the parish office to let us know as soon as possible. If you pay tax and would like to join our Gift Aid Scheme please get in touch with the parish office. Thank you to all who have joined the Gift Aid Scheme

Derry Diocesan Young Adult Community: Derry Youth Ministry invites everyone aged 18–35 to join their new community every Tuesday evening at 7:30pm, starting 20 October, at Claudy Pastoral Centre. Each week features a varied programme including invited speakers, scripture, prayer, food, and fellowship, alongside organised social events. Everyone is welcome to come along! For more details, please contact yvonne.rooney@derrydiocese.org.

SAFEGUARDING Any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children and Vulnerable Adults within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email: dlp@derrydiocese.org Northern Ireland emergency services PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland) 101 Social Services: Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust, 028 7131 4090 (and ask for the Duty Social Worker) Gateway Services, Northern HSC Trust 028 9442 4459 Regional Emergency Social Work Services 0800 1979 99



Sun 18th Oct 2026 Vol 44 No 42

MASSES
Saturday Vigil 6.00pm
Sunday 9.30am, 11.00am, 12.30pm
Mon ,Wed ,Fri, Sat 10.00am Tues and Thurs 7.15pm

CONFESSIONS
Saturdays from 10.30am-11.30am & 5.15pm-5.50pm
Tues ,Thurs 6.45pm – 7.10pm
Divine Mercy 3pm Monday– Friday

BAPTISMS
Saturday at 4.30pm

MARRIAGES
Three months notice and marriage preparation necessary

PAROCHIAL HOUSE
71267070
1 Aileach Road Ballymagroarty BT48 0AZ
Email:office@holyfamily-parish.com
Website: www. holyfamily-parish.com
Webcam: Click on website and follow the links
Parish Office 9.45am-1.45pm Mon– Fri

Parish Priest:
Fr Joseph Gormley

Curate
Fr Kevin Mulhern

GIVING TO GOD OR GIVING TO CAESAR

They must really have thought they had their victim sewn up! If Jesus said he paid the Roman taxes, he recognised the Emperor, not God, as his Lord. If he said he didn't pay, he was a traitor to Rome. Jesus turns the question back on them. First he makes them admit that they themselves recognise Rome as overlord by carrying a Roman coin, for the coin would carry the Emperor's head. Next he puts them a question: what do they consider is due to Caesar?

Finally he goes beyond their question, to interrogate their ultimate loyalty: in the last analysis, just what is due to God? At a superficial level this seems a little verbal tussle, in which Jesus outwits his opponents. But the story was remembered and passed on in the Christian community not because of Jesus' cleverness, but because at a deeper level it is a question which Jesus puts to each of us: just where do our loyalties and priorities lie? Money? Respect? Fame? A good holiday? Comfort? Power?

Jesus is not a dictator who imposes his will. He just asks the question and leave us to give our own answer. To those who question him he gives no easy answer, but always replies with another question.

HOLY FAMILY PARISH DRAW

Our Parish Draw will begin in January 2027 to provide funds for the refurbishment and future capital needs of our Parish. We sincerely hope that the draw will be as successful.

It will run from 1st January 2027 to 31st December 2027 and, if our target number of subscribers is met, the monthly prizes will continue to be £1,000, £500 and £250 for a monthly subscription of **£10 by standing order or cash payment of £120 for year.**

A subscriber to the Draw must be at least 18 years of age.

Registration for the Parish Draw will be open from 1st November 2026 and close on the 17th January 2027. If you would like to help to sell or promote tickets please come to a meeting on Wednesday at 7.00pm in the parish office.

SYMPATHY We offer our sympathy to the family of Ciaran Norrby, Lindenwood Park who died during the week. May he rest in peace.

BAPTISM Our parish family welcomes: Noah Conri McEleney Allingham Close.

NOVENA TO OUR LADY OF PERPETUAL HELP will begin on Tuesday 27th November.

MASS for parishioners who have died during the past year will take place on Wednesday 4th November and Thursday 5th November at 7.15.

ROSARY ON THE COAST. Rosary on the Coast will be at 3pm today Sunday at Benone We will pray for unborn children. Tel 077303 30028

ANNIVERSARIES We pray for those whose anniversaries occur at this time Frank Quinn, Eddie & Rosaleen Keogh, Mary & Kevin McFeeley, Tina Keys, Bernadette Munster, Kieran, John & Annie Mongan,

SUNDAY COLLECTION 4th October £2256.44 & €220.70 Standing Orders £400 **2nd Collection** £1121.30 & €79.06.. Thank you for your generosity

HOLY FAMILY SCRIPTURE GROUP meets on **Thursday at 6.00pm** in the Upper Room This is a sacred time to come together to listen and reflect as Jesus speaks to each of us through His Word in scripture All welcome

PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS TO THE DIOCESAN PRIESTHOOD St Paul could have written this passage from today's Second Reading to our seminarians and to the men discerning their vocation: "We know, brothers, that God loves you and that you have been chosen, because when we brought the Good News to you, it came to you not only as words, but as power and the Holy Spirit and as utter conviction."

LEGION OF MARY meets on Wednesday evenings at 5.45pm. Anyone willing to do Our Lady's work is asked to call Patricia on 02871417867

THORNHILL MINISTRIES will lead an introduction to the practice of praying Scripture in a reflective way that will help participants let the Word of God to nestle in the quiet corner of the heart. '*Open heart - Open to the Word'* series of Sundays in October 3:30 - 4:30 pm Emmaus Room, Pennyburn Church. All welcome

ACCORD DERRY MARRIAGE PREPARATION COURSES January 2027 to March 2027 are now online for booking. The courses can be booked on the website www.accordni.com All of these courses are in person.

JAN 29th/30th FEB19th/20th MAR 19th/20th 2027.

CATHOLIC MARRIAGE ENCOUNTER WEEKEND St. Mary's, Knock, Co. MayoFriday 9th to Sunday 11th April 2027 This residential Weekend starts at 7.30pm on Friday and finishes at 4.30pm on Sunday, and is open to all married couples. Online booking only at www.marriageencounter.ie

Parish of Kilrea & Desertohill

Rev. Christopher McDermott
Parish Secretary: Mrs Kim Convery



Mission Sunday
18th October 2026

www.parishofkilrea.com
E-mail: parishofkilrea@btinternet.com
Facebook: *Parish of Kilrea & Desertohill*
Telephone: 028 29540343

Vigil Mass (Sat) 7pm at Saint Anne's Oratory – Sunday 10am at Drumagarner – Sunday 12noon at Craigavole

Weekday Masses

Monday, Thursday and Friday at 10am in Saint Anne's Oratory.

November Mass for our beloved dead on Friday 6th November at 7.30pm in Drumagarner.

In Remembrance of

Briege McKeefry, Daniel Quinn, Ryan Bradley, Aidan Loftus, Patrick O'Hagan, Francis Lynch and Dan McFaul.
whose anniversaries occur at this time.

Eternal rest grant unto them, O Lord.

Harvest Thanksgiving Service in Tamlaght O' Crilly, Church of Ireland, on Sunday 18th October at 7pm. All welcome.

Our parish family welcomes
Seán-Ciárán Deighan, Maeve Michelle McErlain, Miles Emmet McErlain, Liam Ryan McShane, James Charles Mc Shane and Conlan Patrick Fleming
who were baptised recently.



May they always walk as children of the light!

Last week's collection amounted to £1,905.
September Standing Orders £2,460.
Thank You

First Anniversary Mass for **Colm Mullin** on Saturday 08th November 10am in Drumagarner.

Slaughtneil Bingo

Saturday 24th October 8pm.
11-page book £10. Line £20, House £40. Flyover £50, House £100. Last line £50, House £200.

Vocations: "St Paul could have written this passage from today's Second Reading to our seminarians and to the men discerning their vocation: "We know, brothers, that God loves you and that you have been chosen, because when we brought the Good News to you, it came to you not only as words, but as power and the Holy Spirit and as utter conviction."..... Fr Pat O'Hagan

Kilrea GAC News
Lottery result 24th September: 2,9,15,16.
No Winner £4,200
£50 – Roisin Hanna
Next Jackpot is £4,250. Tickets on Klubfunder.

Safeguarding Notice: Should you have any concerns regarding the safeguarding of children or vulnerable people within the church, please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on 07596500793 or e-mail dlp@derrydiocese.org. PSNI Tel 101. Northern HSCT Gateway Services on 028 9442 4459. Emergency Social Work Services on: 0800 1979 995.

Readers for 24th Oct/25th Oct
7pm:
Sue Anne Mullan
10am:
Pauline Quigg
12noon:
Padraig Quigg

Eucharistic Adoration
Every Monday from 12noon until 7pm at ***Drumagarner.***
Concludes with public prayers.
New participants very welcome!!

ANNUAL POKER NIGHT

James Scullion Memorial Tournament



Saturday 24th October
at **8.30pm Sharp** in **Lavey Club.**

Entry £20 & 1 optional of **£20**
bonus chips if seated for 1st hand.

Proceeds in aid of the Church Restoration Fund.

Tiny Teacher Needed for Roots of Empathy

Do you have a baby aged 2-4 months? St. Brigid's Primary School is looking for a parent and baby to take part in this year's Roots of Empathy programme. Our special **"Tiny Teacher"** will **visit the school on 9 occasions throughout the year (approximately once every three weeks)** to help pupils develop empathy, understanding and respect for others.

Roots of Empathy
Racines de l'empathie

For further information or to express an interest in taking part, please contact Miss McAlister at omcalister487@c2ken.net or telephone the school office on 028 7964 2014.

Gentle Yoga
Gulladuff Cultural & Heritage Centre
Weekly Gentle Yoga begins
Thursday 22nd October at 10.15am.

Autumn Restore & Relax
Thursday 12th November, 7–8.30pm.

Soothing practices to calm the nervous system, release tension and restore balance.
To book contact: **Aileen 0780 5166 750**.





Lavey Parish

Tel: (028) 7964 2458
E-Mail: laveyparish@derrydiocese.org
Web: www.laveyparish.com



Jesus said: **"Give back to Caesar what belongs to Caesar – and to God what belongs to God."** One of the biggest mistakes we make as human beings is to think that what we have belongs to us! The more wonderful truth is that all we have is a gift from God who loves us and who wants us to live in the freedom of that love. The best way of human living is to treasure everything in life rather than try to possess it; to count our blessings rather than moan about what we don't have. And the greatest treasure of all is each other. The quality of our love for one another in marriage and family life is a measure and major part of our worship of God. That love needs to be such that it will radiate out and include those with whom we worship at the Eucharist and so we build a faith community to the glory of God.

Father Johnny Doherty, C.Ss.R.

MASS SCHEDULE

Monday 19th October	**9.15 am Mass**
Anniversary Mass for Josephine McDonald	
Wednesday 21st October	**9.15 am Mass**
Thursday 22nd October	**9.15 am Mass**
Friday 23rd October	**9.15 am Mass**

Adoration** will begin **after morning Mass** and conclude at **5.00 pm.

30th Sunday in Ordinary Time

Saturday 24th October	**5:15 pm - 5:45 pm - Confessions**
	6:00 pm Mass
Sunday 25th October	**9:00 am Mass**
	11:00 am Mass

Rise and Shine Annual Appeal

The Annual Church Gate Collection for **Rise & Shine** at all our Masses next weekend **24th/25th October.**

World Mission Sunday

Today, parishes worldwide celebrate World Mission Sunday. By supporting Missio – the Pope's charity for world mission – we stand united as God's global family, in prayer, solidarity and action. Please pray for missionaries and contribute to the collection, bringing God's compassion, peace and justice to those in need.

Parish Collections: 11th October

Weekly: **£891.00**
Building: **£896.70**
Loose Coin: **£509.53**



Thank you for your continued support!

Sunday 18th October - 29th Sunday in Ordinary Time

*Congratulations to the Committee and Staff of Lavey Early Years on being named **'Early Years Team of the Year'** at the Local Women Education Awards!*

Derry Diocesan Young Adult Community: Derry Youth invites everyone aged **18–35** to join their new community **every Tuesday evening at 7:30pm, starting 20th October, at Claudy Pastoral Centre. Everyone is welcome to come along!** For more details, please contact **yvonne.rooney@derrydiocese.org.**

MASS OF REMEMBRANCE

Our annual Mass of Remembrance for those who have died during the past year in our Parish will take place on **Wednesday 11th November at 7.00pm.**

Our November Deceased List are available at the back of the Church this weekend. When completed please return to the box at the front of the Church.

The parish of Greenlough will hold a Mass in **St Oliver Plunkett Church, Clady, at 7.30pm on Friday 23rd October** to remember all those whose funerals were celebrated under Covid restrictions. Everyone is very welcome.

Sacred Heart Messenger

The subscription for the 2027 Sacred Heart Messenger is now due of **£26**. Please return payment to the Parish Office or Sacristy. Please make cheques payable to **Lavey Parish**.

Please Remember: Clocks go back 1 hour next weekend!



Parishes of Camus, Clonleigh and Leckpatrick
Twenty-Ninth Sunday in Ordinary Time - Year A - 18th October 2026
Parish Clergy: Fr Michael McCaughey, PP: (028) 71882274 / (028) 71882215
Fr Declan Boland (priest in residence)
Email: leckpatrickparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website**: www.leckpatrickparish.com
Email: strabaneparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.camusparish.com
Email: clonleighparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website**: www.clonleighparish.com

Gospel Reflection *(Matthew 22:15-21)*

In today's gospel, religious leaders try to trap Jesus with a question about paying taxes to Caesar. Pointing to the coin's image and inscription, He teaches us to fulfil our earthly responsibilities while giving our deepest allegiance to God. Jesus reminds us that not every question deserves a fight. What matters is whether our choices reflect goodness, truth, and love, drawing us closer to God,
strengthening our character, and blessing others. A life well lived is measured not by arguments won, but by faithfulness to God's will.
The coin carried Caesar's image, reminding us to respect legitimate laws, perform our duties honestly, support our families, and contribute positively to society. Faith does not excuse us from responsible citizenship; it inspires us to fulfil our duties with sincerity and fairness. The coin bore Caesar's image, but our lives are called to reflect God's goodness. Though we cannot do so perfectly every day, we can choose to grow: let our words encourage, our hands help, and our hearts forgive.
We may give money to the world, time to our responsibilities, and attention to our ambitions, but we must give God what belongs to Him: our love, worship, gratitude, trust, and obedience. Our relationship with God remains the foundation of a meaningful life.
We may carry coins in our pockets, but we carry God's calling in our hearts. Give the world your honest service, others your genuine love, and God your whole heart. That is how an ordinary life becomes a beautiful offering to Him.

Today is World Mission Sunday October has been the month of universal mission since 1926. Mission Sunday invites Catholics to unite with missionaries worldwide and recommit to the Church's missionary activity through prayer, sacrifice and financial support. Funds help young churches and missionaries serve communities in need, both spiritually and materially. Contributions build mission churches, educate seminarians, form catechists and lay leaders, fund children's
health clinics, provide emergency aid in war or disaster, and help missionaries care for refugees. This year's theme is 'One in Christ, united in mission'. Today we celebrate our c. 1,500 Irish-born missionaries and all missionaries worldwide, thanking God for them, for those who support them at home, and for our growing communion with them and the communities they serve. To read
Pope Leo's message for World Mission Sunday, please visit MESSAGE-OF-HISHOLINESS-POPE-LEO-XIV-for-WMS-2026.pdf

Requiescat in Pace We offer our sympathy of the family and friends of
Martin Gallagher, Guystown, Ballindrait, Lifford

Anniversaries Jean Allen, Martin Blee, Kathleen Coups, Gerry Crawford, Joseph Dunne, Tommy Dunne, Mary Elliott, Mary Alice Elliott, Annie Feeney, Charles Flanagan, Pat McColgan, Willie McCullagh, Daniel Gerald McFadden, Daniel McGllion, Ryan McGonigle, Bridie O'Donnell, Paddy O'Donnell, Paddy O'Kane, Philomena O'Kane, Pat Quinn, Rose Roulston, Gerry Strawbridge. Rest in peace.

9.45am Mass on Sundays in Murlog Chapel is live on Finn Valley Community Radio.

Thank You for your generosity to last week's collections
Leckpatrick £1,204.37
Clonleigh €1,969.94
Camus £1,534.14.
Thanks to those who pay by standing order.

Readings for Sunday 25th October:
1st Reading: Exodus 22:20-26
Psalm: 18:2-3,3-4, 47, 51
2nd Reading: 1 Thessalonians 1:5c-10
Gospel: Matthew 22:34-40

Saints of the Coming Week:
Monday St John de Brebeuf, St Isaac Jogues, priests and companions, martyrs
St Paul of the Cross, priest
Thursday St John Paul II, pope
Friday St John of Capistrano, priest
Saturday St Anthony Mary Claret, bishop

St Patrick's Church, Murlog We wish to remind all parishioners that the **Vigil Mass** at St Patrick's, Murlog is now at **6.00 pm**, until further notification. We thank you all for your cooperation and understanding.

Annual Day of Prayer, Praise and Healing takes place on Sunday 15th November in the Silver Birch Hotel, Omagh. Registration at 9.30 am and concluding with celebration of Mass and Healing Service in the afternoon. Guest speaker is Fr John Keane. Theme: 'People of God's Delight' (Ps 149.4). The day is organised by Omagh Charismatic Prayer Group which celebrates its 50th anniversary. All welcome.

ACCORD Derry Marriage Preparation Courses Dates: 29th/30th January, 19th/20th February & 19th/20th March 2027 are now available to book. Please visit www.accordni.com Courses are in person in Everglades Hotel, Derry.

Class Act Theatre Group presents *Fame, The Musical* at St Patrick's Hall, Strabane, from 2nd - 6th November. This exciting production will showcase the talents of almost 100 local young people, providing a wonderful opportunity for the community to support and celebrate local talent on stage. Audiences can look forward to an energetic and uplifting performance featuring a large cast of dedicated young performers. Given the popularity of previous Class Act productions, early booking is strongly recommended. Tickets can be booked online via the Class Act Theatre Group website: www.classacttheatregroup.co.uk/events

Global Rosary for Peace in the Tradition of Venerable Patrick Peyton Join hundreds of thousands of Catholics praying for peace on Thursday 22nd October at 3 pm (GMT), the Feast of St John Paul the Great. Visit Pray for peace – HCFM to register and to watch live on Thursday.

Fatima Pilgrimage 2027 led by spiritual director, Fr Sean O'Donnell on 5th July 2027. Cost: £950 pps. £100 off if paid in full by 30/11/26. 7 nights full board in Hotel Cinquentenario. Please contact Patricia 07743936548 / Anne 07784953408.

Book of Memories of Father Paddy O'Kane A new book is being planned about well known Derry priest, Fr Paddy O'Kane, who died in 2022. Due for publication next year, it will include memories and stories from those who knew him, alongside selections from his Derry News column. If you have a memory or story to share, author Ciaran O'Neill would be delighted to hear from you. Email: caoneill1971@gmail.com or phone: 07875 904354.

Coffee Morning - St Patrick's NS, Murlog You are invited to a Coffee Morning in the GP room on Monday 19th October anytime between 10 am and 12 noon. This invitation is open to everyone. Call in, enjoy a cuppa and some home baking. All money raised will go towards school funds.

Pray for Vocations What does God want you to be? If you think you may have a vocation to serve as a priest of the Derry Diocese, please contact your local priest or Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan on 028 79386259 / pgoh2111@gmail.com

The Next Diocesan Vocations Holy Hours will take place on Tuesday 20th October, 3rd November & 1st December from 8 - 9 pm, following 7.30 pm Mass in St Columb's Church, Chapel Road, Waterside, Derry. Everyone welcome.

Abide Women's Conference from 20th - 22nd November at Great Northern Hotel, Bundoran. Speakers include Sarah Swafford, Fr Barry Braun, Fr Mark Wharton, Kimberlee WooLing, Danielle Noonan, Nashville Dominicans, etc. Mass will be celebrated by Bishop Fintan Gavin, Cork & Ross diocese. Please visit Abide in His Love at Eventbrite.ie. Registration at https://abide inhislove.eventbrite.com

Donegal Hospice Bethany Bereavement Support Group is a free, confidential listening service. Please tel 0894402787 between 10 am and 9 pm daily.

Legion of Mary New members are needed. Role includes visitation of nursing homes, promotion of the rosary with the pilgrim statue and weekly meetings. Meeting on Thursday at 11 am in St Pat's Hall. Please tel Margaret 028 71883159.

Catholic Marriage Encounter Weekend takes place in St Mary's, Knock, Co Mayo from Friday 9th - Sunday 11th April 2027. This residential weekend starts at 7.30 pm on Friday and finishes at 4.30 pm on Sunday, and is open to all married couples. Online booking only at www.marriageencounter.ie

St Columba's Church, Long Tower Solemn Novena of Healing in Honour of Our Lady of Perpetual Help and to Celebrate the Jubilee of St Francis of Assisi takes place on the nine Sundays before Christmas, beginning on Sunday 25th October at 6.00 pm, with a guest speaker each week. Everyone welcome.

Derry Diocesan Young Adult Community Derry Youth Ministry invites everyone aged 18–35 to join their new community every Tuesday evening at 7.30pm, starting 20th October, at Claudy Pastoral Centre. Each week features a varied programme including invited speakers, scripture, prayer, food, and fellowship, alongside organised social events. Everyone is welcome to come along! For more details, please contact yvonne.rooney@derrydiocese.org

St Patrick's National School / Scoil Mhuire gan Smal – Job Vacancy Part-time Caretaker Role (25 hrs per week – shared role between two schools). Seeking a reliable, hardworking and dedicated caretaker to join the friendly school communities. We are looking for someone who will take pride in ensuring both school sites are safe, secure, clean and well maintained. CVs to be received by post before the closing date of 3 pm on Thursday 22nd October, to either: St Patrick's NS, Murlog, Lifford, Co Donegal F93 AP93, or Lifford NS, Townsparks, Lifford, Co Donegal F93 DE28. For further information please contact the schools.

Flu Vaccination – Walk In will be held in Lifford Health Centre on Monday 19th October from 6 - 8 pm. No appointment needed.

Mass Cards / Mass Bouquets are available from the parish office.

Rosary on the Coast takes place today (Sunday) at 3.00 pm at Benone Strand, praying for peace, Ireland and our unborn babies. All welcome.

The Contemplative Prayer Group meetings resume on Mondays at 8.00 pm in the Pastoral Office, 27 Butcher Street, Strabane. Everyone welcome.

Parish Bingo and Lucky Four in St Pat's Hall on Thursdays at 8 pm. Some fun, excitement and slight competition. Everyone welcome.